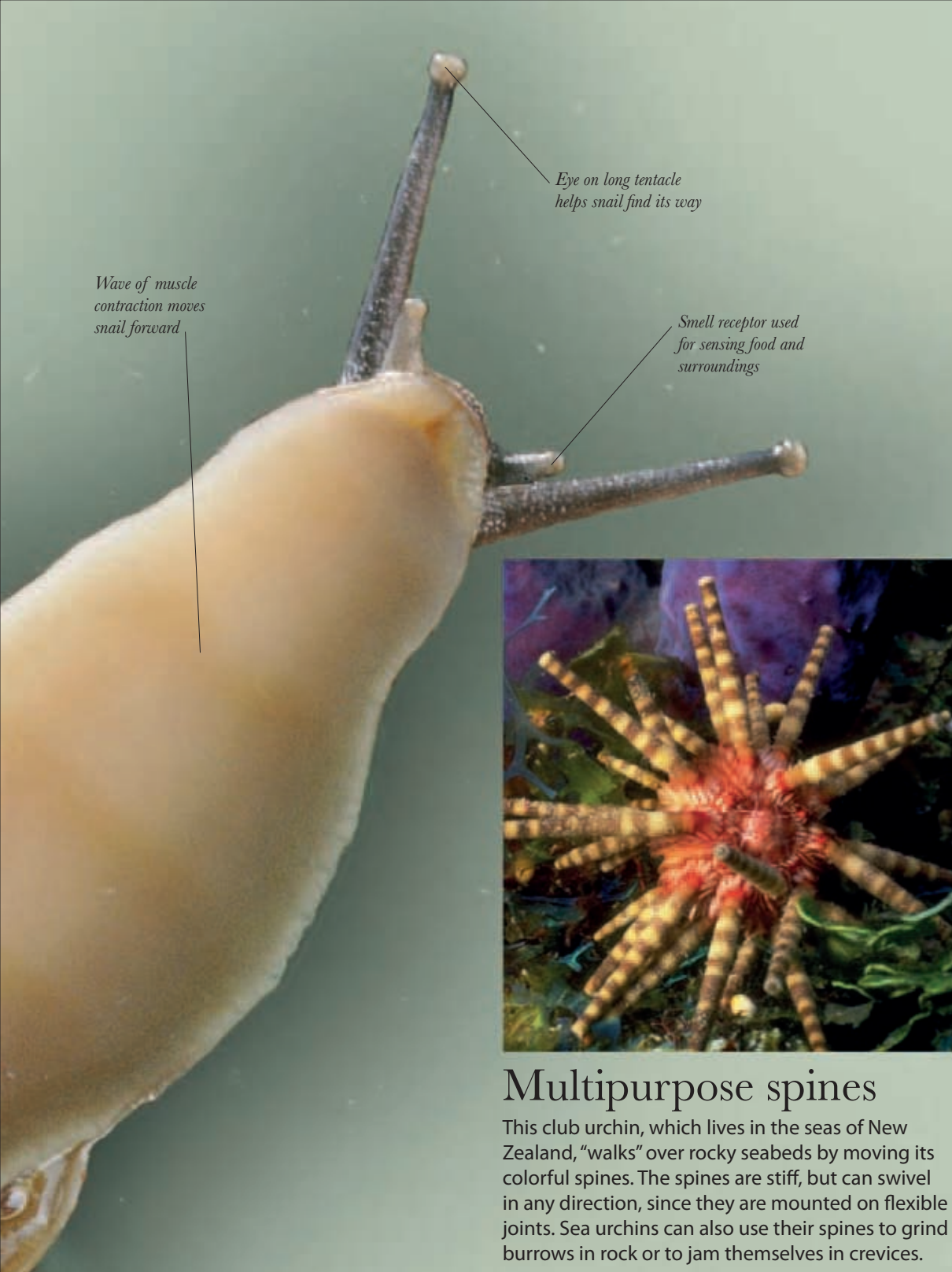




Eye on long tentacle helps snail find its way

Wave of muscle contraction moves snail forward

Smell receptor used for sensing food and surroundings



Multipurpose spines

This club urchin, which lives in the seas of New Zealand, "walks" over rocky seabeds by moving its colorful spines. The spines are stiff, but can swivel in any direction, since they are mounted on flexible joints. Sea urchins can also use their spines to grind burrows in rock or to jam themselves in crevices.

Staying put

These goose barnacles start their lives as tiny larvae, which use their feathery legs to swim near the surface of the sea. After months adrift, they change shape and fasten themselves to rocks. From that moment onward, they never move again. Instead of swimming to find food, they collect it as it drifts past. This way of life is shared by many invertebrates, from corals to giant clams.



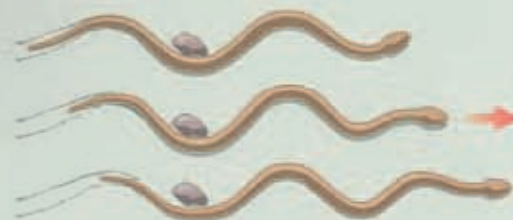
How snakes slither

Snakes have four different ways of moving. Many use two or three methods, switching them to suit the ground they are traveling over and to match the speed they need. Sidewinding is a special kind of movement used by snakes that live in deserts and other habitats with loose ground.



Straight-line movement

When snakes creep in straight lines, they raise the scales on their undersides, moving them forward in waves. The scales push the snake forward when they touch the ground. This kind of movement is used by heavy snakes that have wide belly scales.



Serpentine movement

When a snake presses against an object with its side, it produces a backward thrust, which makes the snake slide forward. Most snakes use this kind of movement on land. Speeded up, they also use it when they swim, by pushing against the water.



Accordion movement

On smooth ground, snakes often fold into curves. Using their tails as anchors, they reach forward with their heads and necks. The neck curves up, turning into the anchor, and the tail catches up. Snakes also use their coils as an anchor when they climb in trees.



Sidewinding

Instead of crawling, a sidewinding snake lifts its head and neck and throws them sideways through the air. The rest of its body follows, while its head moves on again. Used by rattlesnakes and vipers, sidewinding leaves a series of J-shaped tracks in the sand.